

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Deal 1 Ctr: 6♠ Goal: at most ____ losers

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 2 Ctr: 6♥ Goal: at most ____ losers

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 3 Ctr: 7♥ Goal: at most ____ losers

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 4 Ctr: 6♥ Goal: at most ____ losers

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6 ♠
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6 ♥
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 7 ♥
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6 ♥
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: North

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 6 ♥
Declarer: East

Deal 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ T 7 2
♥ T 9 7 2
♦ K T 9 5 3
♣ 7

19
3 5
13

♠ A J 9 6 3
♥ A 4
♦ A Q J 6
♣ K 5



♠ K Q 8 5
♥ J 6 3
♦ 8 7
♣ A Q J 4

♠ 4
♥ K Q 8 5
♦ 4 2
♣ T 9 8 6 3 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♠
Pass	5NT	Pass	6 ♣
Pass	6 ♠		
All Pass			
6 ♠ by North			

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When SOUTH gives immediate ♠ support,
NORTH's thoughts naturally

turn to slam. This is a good hand to use
Blackwood on, so NORTH bids 4NT.

SOUTH's 5

♦

answer shows one Ace, which NORTH
cleverly deduces

must be the ♣A.

NORTH bids 6 ♠ since SOUTH has not bid
strongly enough to think about 7.

Deal 2

West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K Q J
♥ A K T
♦ K Q 2
♣ K Q 7 3

5
23 8
4

♠ T 9 8 7 3

♥ 5 3 2

♦ T 7

♣ A J 2



♠ 5 2

♥ 6

♦ A 6 5 4

♣ T 9 8 6 5 4

♠ A 6 4

♥ Q J 9 8 7 4

♦ J 9 8 3

♣ -

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WEST expects to bid 2NT at his second turn,
but EAST gives a positive 2



response and his thinking changes! First he
supports



s, setting the

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	3♠	Pass
4NT	Pass	6♣	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			
6♥ by East			

WEST bids 6



, knowing they must lose the



A.

trump suit.

EAST then bids 3♠, showing first round
control. WEST tries 4NT (Blackwood) and

EAST replies 6♣. This shows a ♣ void and
one Ace, obviously the ♠A.

Deal 3

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q J 9 3
♥ 2
♦ Q 5 2
♣ K T 5 3 2

11
8 7
14

♠ A 8 4 2
♥ Q J 8 6
♦ A 9 8 6 3
♣ -



♠ K 5
♥ A K T 7 5 3
♦ K 7
♣ J 9 6

♠ T 7 6
♥ 9 4
♦ J T 4
♣ A Q 8 7 4

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	5NT	Pass	7♥
All Pass			
7♥ by South			

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NORTH's jump to 4♣ is a Splinter bid, at least 4-card

♥

support,

at least opening hand, and a ♣ Singleton or Void.

SOUTH bids 4NT, Blackwood.

NORTH's 5NT reply shows two Aces and a Void somewhere, obviously ♣s.

SOUTH counts thirteen tricks and bids 7

♥

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 5 3
♥ K Q J T 3
♦ A
♣ K Q T 6

7
18 8
7

♠ T 7 6 2
♥ 8 4 2
♦ Q J 5 3
♣ A 4



♠ A Q J 9 8 4
♥ 6
♦ T 7 2
♣ 8 7 5

♠ -
♥ A 9 7 5
♦ K 9 8 6 4
♣ J 9 3 2

West

1♥

4NT

All Pass

6♥ by West

North

Pass

Pass

East

3♥

6♥

South

Pass

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WEST figures that if EAST holds two Aces he will bid the slam.

EAST only has one Ace, but she has something else just as good - a void in a suit which

is higher-ranking than



s.

WEST manages to figure out that EAST has a ♠ void and bids the slam anyway.

Deal 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q
♥ T 6
♦ T 9 4 3 2
♣ A Q T 9 8

17
8 7
8

♠ A 9 8 6 4

♥ A K Q

♦ 7

♣ K J 6 3



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ J 8 7

♦ A 8 6 5

♣ 7 4

♠ J T 2
♥ 9 5 4 3 2
♦ K Q J
♣ 5 2

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NORTH may have a good hand but SOUTH merely gave a simple raise.

Even if SOUTH has a maximum there won't be a slam.

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠		2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

Deal 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 7 5 3
 ♥ T 9 4 2
 ♦ A 8
 ♣ K J 4

6
 10 16
 8

♠ K J 8 4 2

♥ 5

♦ Q 6 5 4

♣ 9 8 7



♠ A T 9 6

♥ A 7

♦ T 9 7 3

♣ T 3 2

♠ -

♥ K Q J 8 6 3

♦ K J 2

♣ A Q 6 5

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EAST has a tough decision after the two
 Control-showing bids.

If he uses Blackwood and WEST shows two
 Aces he will be no better off, because he won't
 know if one

of the Aces is the useless ♠A. Based on
 knowing that WEST holds the

♦

West

North

East

South

A,

3♥

Pass

1♥

Pass

he bids 6

4♦

Pass

4♣

Pass

♥

All Pass

6♥

6♥ by East

, hoping that he can at least make that and that 7 isn't a laydown!